

Plot Summary

Life After is a retrofuturistic musical about a marine biologist and an angel investor bunkered down in an abyss, having believed the world is swept away in 2012. When an explorer runs into their habitat, the pair find themselves swept up in the decision to return to life on land or life with their underwater friends.

Set in an underwater habitat in 2013, Thuy Duc and Adrienne Harbor assume of humanity's extinction in 2012 ("Life Before"). Adrienne is caught in the toils of their own financial sacrifices, having spent all their wealth on reinforcing their habitat for a lifetime. However, Thuy keeps themselves at bay by observing the deep-sea community. They befriended the baby giant squids. They never had this many friends in their lives ("Colossal Breakthrough").

Their world turns upside down when an explorer in a submarine runs into the habitat. Moses Whalen reveals that the world never ended. Adrienne pleads for Moses's help as the baby giant squids decommissioned their escape pod after they assumed it to be another giant squid. Adrienne also cannot take Thuy's conversations with the squids anymore. Moses has been out looking for giant squids when they saw the first footage of one broadcasted in January 2013. Now, Moses's duty is to get Thuy and Adrienne to the surface ("Waste of Time").

Thuy reveals that they told the baby giant squids to sabotage their escape pod and communication to land. Furious but self-restrained, Adrienne threatens to leave their friendship behind. Thuy hesitantly joins Moses with Adrienne.

As they ascend, a giant squid stops them and damages the sub. The giant squid sees Thuy as a neighbor who looked after their squid kids while they went out hunting. Thuy convinces the giant squid to lift them up to the surface. They both wave goodbye ("Life After").

Fin.

CAST OF CHARACTERS

THUY "Twee" DUC, adult, a marine biologist

ADRIENNE "A-Dree-Un" HARBOR, adult, an angel investor

MOSES WHALEN, adult, an explorer and submarine puppeteer

Puppeteer, anyone, the one handling the sea creature puppets

● Queer People of the Global Majority most represent the experiences of these underwater humans; cast accordingly

MUSICAL NUMBERS

1. "Life Before (The End of the World)" Thuy, Adrienne
2. "Colossal Discovery" Thuy, Adrienne
3. "Waste of Time" Moses, Thuy, Adrienne
4. "Life After (The End of the World)" Thuy, Adrienne, Moses